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Studien zur suffixalen Nominalbildung zu einer Bilanzierung der lateinischen Wortbildung im Ganzen weiterführt.

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Gerschner, Robert: Die Deklination der Nomina bei Plautus. Heidelberg, Universitätsverlag C. Winter, 2002, gr.-8°, 208 S. (Indogermanische Bibliothek: Reihe 3.) Brosch. 31 €.

This revised University of Vienna dissertation provides a highly systematic (and frequently revealing) survey of Plautine nominal declension, viewed primarily from a synchronic perspective and in comparison with Classical norms. The book also includes numerous analyses of problematic forms and related linguistic and metrical issues, considered both synchronically and diachronically. The brief introductory chapter (with methodological and bibliographical background) is followed by five extended treatments of the Latin declensional classes (one chapter each) as they appear in Plautus; each chapter is identically articulated, with a brief overview giving way to sections on all categories of case and number (nom./voc. sg., then gen. sg., etc.), and a "Zusammenfassung". A final chapter of "Ergänzende Beobachtungen" treats three issues of general interest for the material as a whole (variation in gender, variation of inflectional class, and the declension of Greek words), together with an excursus on *oleum* and *deus*. Two pages of concluding remarks are followed by extensive (but flawed) bibliographical indications, an index locorum for Plautine passages, and a word index (covering Latin words only, though much material from Greek, and some material from other languages, is also cited throughout the book).

While one applauds the author's generally solid command of the relevant literature (though see n. 2 below, ad fin.), the bibliography has been poorly executed in an important respect: at least a dozen items to which the author refers in his text, including three from the pen of one of his dissertation advisors ("Eichner 1974", "Eichner 1989", "Eichner 1993a"; further "Adams 1985", "Christol", "Katz 1985", "Leumann 1928", "Russell 1988", "Schrijnen", "Simone"/"de Simone", "Schwyzer", "Weiss"), are nowhere to be found in his bibliographical material. Alas, it may only be the rare specialist who would realize, for example, that "Weiss" (so cited on p. 141) refers to the unpublished Cornell University dissertation of M. Weiss (1993), with important analyses of Latin and It-

alic nominal morphology – thus a work of central importance for G.'s topic.[1]

As is usual for such surveys, the book's central findings (more on which below) are not materially weakened by many points of detail where alternative analyses are possible or even preferable. Judgments about such material will differ from one scholar to the next, and it is hardly necessary to treat such matters exhaustively here.[2] Rather, the book's most serious problem arises from its very format and conception: while appropriate for a dissertation, the book's "agglutinative" structure, with its many episodic and fragmented treatments of each and every case form in each and every declension class, entails considerable repetition; and it is no doubt the origin of the work as a dissertation that accounts for the inclusion of distracting stretches of extraneous material.[3]

All of this has two major consequences for the work, of which the first is that no room was left for more extended discussions of central issues, beyond the three selected for treatment in the final chapter. Thus, despite the author's sensitive attention to meter at many points in the work, one misses a systematic treatment of the interaction of meter and nominal morphology (especially at line-end), of particular interest in view of many instances in which the author claims that this or that form is "am Versende wohl metrisch bedingt" (178, with reference to *o*-stem acc. *Tranium* at Mo. 560, vs. *n*-stem inflection elsewhere), among other forms of metrical/morphological interaction.[4] Further, and more importantly, many of G.'s analyses are of necessity (given the format he has chosen) sketchy and superficial, ultimately limiting the book's potential contribution to

[1] Other errors rarely engender confusion (exceptions are "<" for ">" [89 Anm. 1] and "Watkins 1965" [120] for "1965b"), though one is surprised by a series of wrongly-marked vowel quantities (*Aenaeādum* [49, for *Aeneadum*; Lucr. I.1!], *dēcus* [99, 100], *hilāris* and *hilārus* [170, 9x]).

[2] Two small items that can be mentioned in brief compass, by way of example: TITA in the sequence TITA()VENDIAS (AE 1954, 219ab) is better not adduced as support for OLat. gen. sg. f. *-ās* (thus TITA<s>()VENDIAS for G. [38], as for others), cf. Watkins 1995:129 (on TITA as nom. sg.); and despite the communis opinio (repeated by G., 171), Lat. *lacrima* (OLat. *dacruma*) is not likely to be borrowed from Gk. δάκρυμα, as already seen by Brugmann and as Nussbaum has recently argued in detail (1999: 394 f.). Here it can be noted that the opportunity to revise this 2000 dissertation for a 2002 publication seems not to have allowed for consultation of bibliography later than 1999; and the sole bibliographical item G. cites from 1999 is a paper (by B. Forssman) from the same collection in which Nussbaum's article appeared.

[3] E.g.: an extended discussion of problems surrounding some non-Plautine *ā*-stem gen. pl. forms (49) turns out to have no real bearing on Plautus, where no such problematic forms are attested; similarly, the lengthy discussion of the historical background of the *o*-stem gen. sg. (63 f.) is standard handbook fare, with no real connection to the Plautine material.

[4] While one cannot fault an author for failing to write a book he did not intend to write, it is still a pity that no room was found for comparative discussion of nominal declension in Terence and other early authors (a desideratum noted by the author himself, 186).

our understanding of the history of Latin nominal morphology. Thus, in a discussion of aberrant forms (mostly names) based on Greek declensional patterns (177 ff.), G. provides a note (179) on the treatment of Gk. Βελλεροφόντης (Hom.), Βελλεροφῶν (Theoc. +) in Plautus, where it is attested once (Ba. 810): G. cites (inaccurately) the MS variants *bellero phantam iam* [sic] (B), *bellero phontem iam* [sic] (ceteri codd.),[5] whence the apparent Plautine form *Bellerophontem*,[6] emended by Ritschl to the *ā*-stem form *Bellerophontam* (sic).[7] Such an *ā*-stem form, G. observes, would be comparable to *Apella* (Ep. 626, Po. 1271) and **Thyesta* (*Thyestae* Ru. 509), which he discusses directly following, noting once again (180) that Ritschl's *Bellerophantam*, if correct, would point to an *ā*-stem. But the status of this form, and its evaluation as an *ā*-stem, is a more complex matter, as shown by some crucial information omitted from G.'s cursory treatment. The attestation of this name at Ba. 810 cannot be considered without reference to OLat. Melerpanta (CIL I^2 554, Praeneste); and this form in turn has been thought (at least since Ernout 1905:316; similarly Matthies 1912:51, and more recently Ernout 1966:31, de Simone 1968:2.185) to be related to an Etruscan source of the type **Pelerpanta*. Recent prominent discussions of Praen. Melerpanta (Wachter 1987:120 f., §49d; Mancini 1997:323 ff.), though very different in their approaches to the Etruscan background of the Praenestine form, both make clear its connection to the Plautine attestation, a connection that was in fact the cornerstone of Ritschl's original treatment (1866:IV.295 f.).[8] This perspective – which ultimatively includes a probable Doric source Βελλεροφόντᾱς – is entirely lacking both in G.'s treatment of the Plautine form and in his evaluation of comparable ones inflected as *ā*-stems, including his general conclusion on such matters (181): there he is content merely to point out the attested morphological variation in Plautus' rendering of Greek names in *-ης* (found in 1st-, 3rd-, and 5th-declension forms), as a corrective to Leumann's bald assertion (1977:458) that such names are inflected according to the 5th declension. Rather, G. writes, the inflection of this type in Old Latin appears to have been "wenig reguliert". That much is true; but the failure to consider the full background of the Plautine version of (NB: Doric) Βελλεροφόντᾱς has deprived G. of the opportunity, first of all, to evaluate the *ā*-stem inflection of the form properly (the existence of such an *ā*-stem can hardly be doubted), and, further, to explore in greater depth the linguistic background of such *ā*-stem forms as **Bellerophanta* (or **Bellorophanta*), *Apella*, and **Thyesta*, beyond the simple fact of declensional variation or "irregularity".

These reservations should not obscure the considerable merits of the work, which include, not least of all, a number of insights about individ-

[5] Properly *bello rophantem iam* (B), *bello rophontem iam* (ceteri codd.).

[6] Thus e.g. Fleckeisen (1879, but cf. n. 7 below), similarly *Bellorophontem* (Leo, Ernout, Questa).

[7] Ritschl conjectured *Bellerophantam* (thus also Ritschl-Goetz, cf. Lindsay [OCT] *Bellorophantam*); as noted in the apparatus of Ritschl-Goetz, Fleckeisen had earlier (1866) defended *Bellorophantam*.

[8] Cf. also TLL II (1900–1906), 1808.36 s.v. *Bellerophontes* ("*Bellorophantes* ... cf. *Melerpanta*").

ual forms and passages, not readily summarizable here but easily accessible via G.'s indices verborum et locorum. More generally, his analyses collectively demonstrate – I think convincingly – that Plautus' nominal morphology, as such, is not as "archaic" as it is reflexively assumed to be, but rather approximates, in many essential respects, to Classical norms, and thus might just as accurately be termed "modern". The major discrepancies with Classical Latin primarily involve a series of phonological processes that have not yet run their course (such as the monophthongization of *ei* to *ī*), and a restricted range of morphological doublets for various endings (e.g. *ā*-stem gen. sg. *-ae/-āī/-ās*, cf. also the mixed declension of Greek names, as above). Yet even for such morphological variation, G. shows that in many instances, a series of well-defined lexical, stylistic, and metrical factors is at work. If the nature and format of the book have left room for further discussion of many such problems, we can be grateful to G. for having provided such a useful framework for future research on early Latin nominal declension.

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